Copy of 2024 - Subject Evaluation Report CHEM325 Bioinformatics: Genome, Genes and Biomolecules Spring

Project Title: **Spring/ Tri 3 2024 - Subject and Lecturer Evaluations**

Subject Enrolments: **77**
Responses Received: **15**
Response Rate: **19.48%**

Report Comments

This report combines subject evaluation results for all instances where a subject is taught across multiple campuses or modes in a single session.

The report provides:

- SEBS response rate and basic respondent demographics
- Overall evaluation ratings and ratings for each question
- Comparisons with your school for the current session
- Free-text comments – providing valuable information on aspects important to students and suggestions for improvements.

If you have any questions about this report, contact uow-evaluations@uow.edu.au.

Interpreting the data

- Subject Instance Reports are generated only when six or more students complete the survey. However, the results for subjects with fewer than six respondents are included in the aggregate reports.
- Response rates of less than 10% should be interpreted with caution.
- A numeric value is assigned to each response. These are used to calculate the average (mean) for each question. Values assigned are:
  - Strongly Agree (6)
  - Agree (5)
  - Mildly Agree (4)
  - Mildly Disagree (3)
  - Disagree (2)
  - Strongly Disagree (1)
  - Unable to Judge (not counted)
- **An overall subject mean is calculated on the 10 core questions only** - Any additional questions included in the survey are not counted towards the mean.
- Mean scores can hide extremes in responses, as such, you are encouraged to also utilise response distribution and percentage agreeable metrics.

About the SEBS Survey

The SEBS survey has been designed as a tool to assist Subject Coordinators to evaluate their subject(s) in order to assess their impact on student learning. These reports should be compared with, and supported by, information obtained from other sources such as student focus groups, self-reflections and peer reviews. Subject Coordinators are asked to document their reflections (including identified actions to maintain and enhance subject quality) in the Subject Reflection Database on their Faculty Quality Assurance (QA) Moodle Site.

See the Evaluation of Learning and Teaching website for further information.

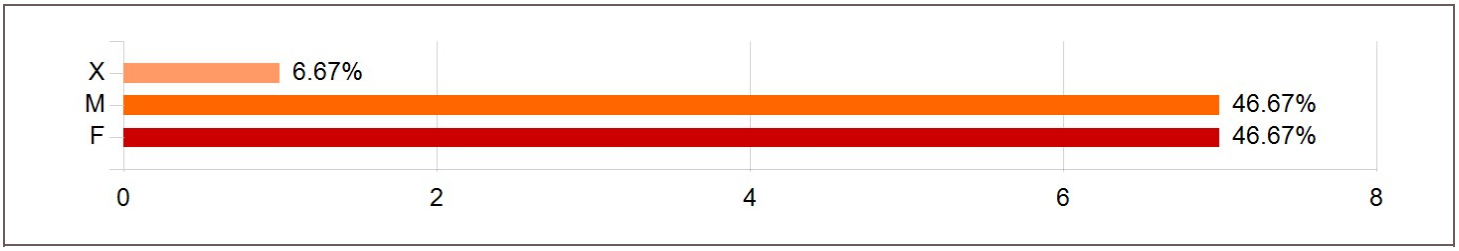
Closing the feedback loop

Let your students know what changes you make to the subject, in response to your reflections and feedback (including from the SEBS survey) in the next iteration of the Subject Outline.

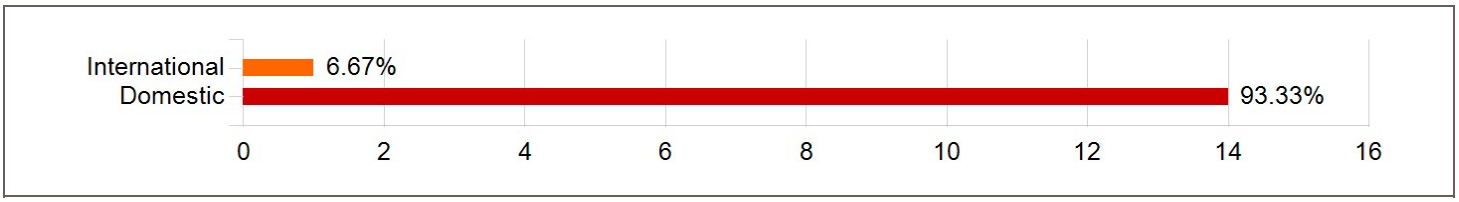
Creation Date: **Tuesday, December 3, 2024**

About the Respondents

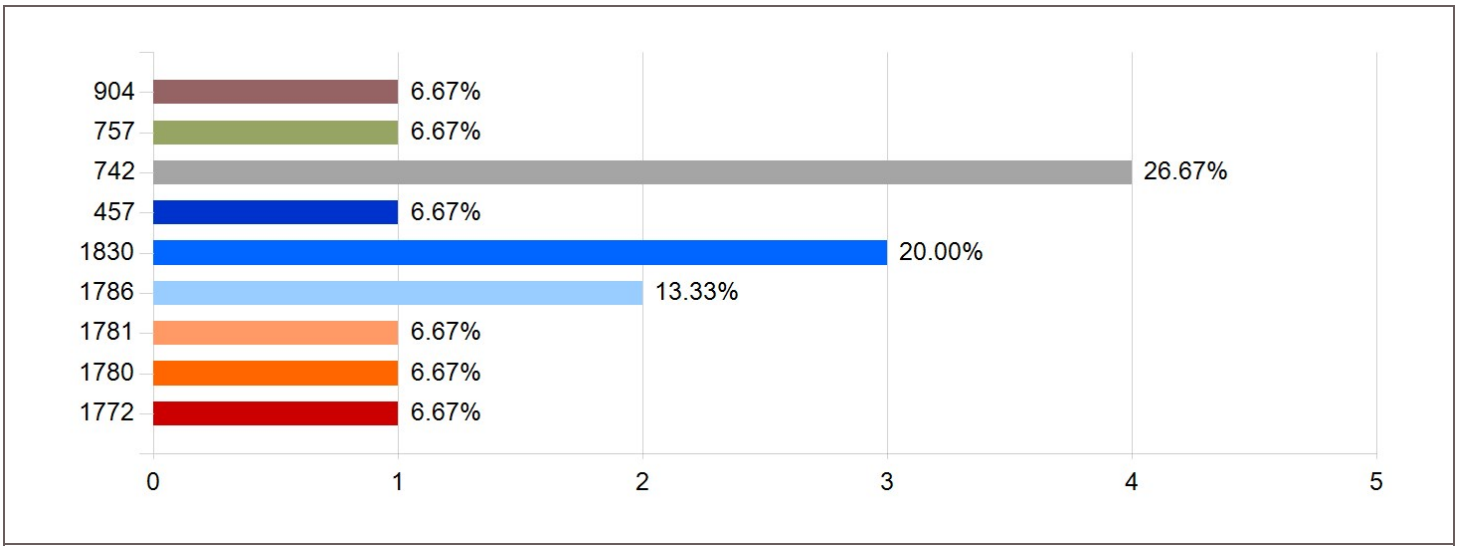
Gender breakdown



Domestic/International breakdown



Course breakdown



Reliability Assessment Score (RAS)

The RAS gives you an indication of the reliability of the data reflecting accurately the views of the student cohort. Results will be classified as insufficient, sufficient or good. Where scores are considered insufficient we encourage you to review the statistical information with caution and focus instead on the free text comments.

With 15 responses from a survey population of 77, the data presented in this report is considered to be **Insufficient**
Number of responses needed to be considered sufficient: 16
Number of responses needed to be considered good: 39

Results Summary

Note: The session average score includes all surveys completed across UOW for the current session

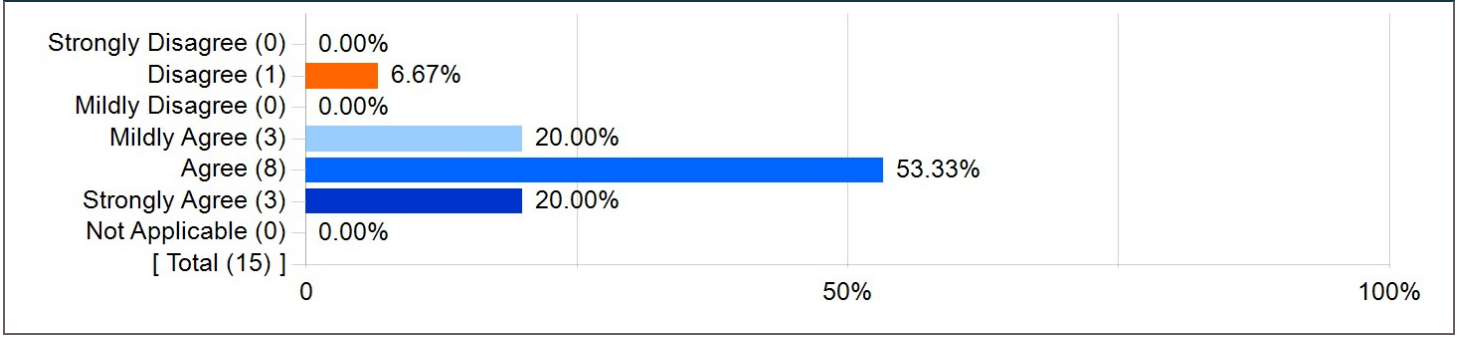
Subject Evaluation Questions

Note: The response count excludes 'Unable to Judge' responses

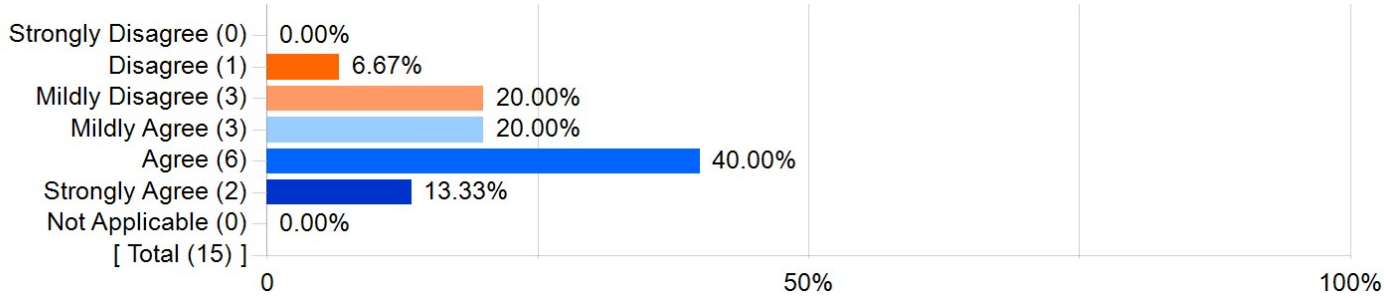
Question	Subject (CHEM325)				School (School of Chemistry and Molecular Bioscience)			
	Response Count	Mean	Min	Max	Response Count	Mean	Min	Max
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	15	4.80	2.00	6.00	918	5.39	1.00	6.00
Content organised in a clear and logical way	15	4.33	2.00	6.00	918	5.29	1.00	6.00
Subject challenged my thinking	15	5.07	3.00	6.00	917	5.42	1.00	6.00
Learning materials aided my learning	15	4.53	3.00	6.00	914	5.32	1.00	6.00
Technology aided my learning	15	4.53	3.00	6.00	912	5.28	1.00	6.00
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	15	4.87	4.00	6.00	915	5.22	1.00	6.00
Assessment tasks clearly stated	15	4.20	2.00	6.00	918	5.24	1.00	6.00
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	15	4.53	2.00	6.00	918	5.23	1.00	6.00
Timely feedback helped my learning	15	3.73	1.00	6.00	905	5.06	1.00	6.00
Overall satisfaction	15	4.47	2.00	6.00	918	5.22	1.00	6.00
Overall Mean	-	4.51	-	-	-	5.27	-	-

Response Analysis - Core Questions

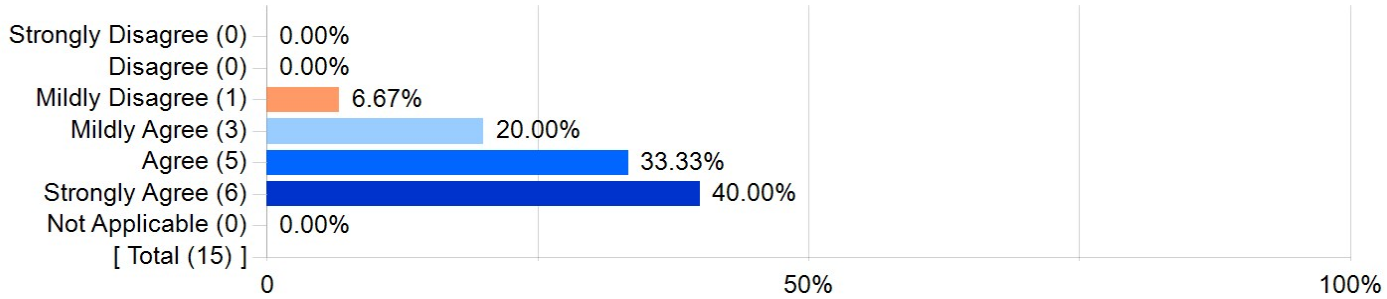
1. Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes



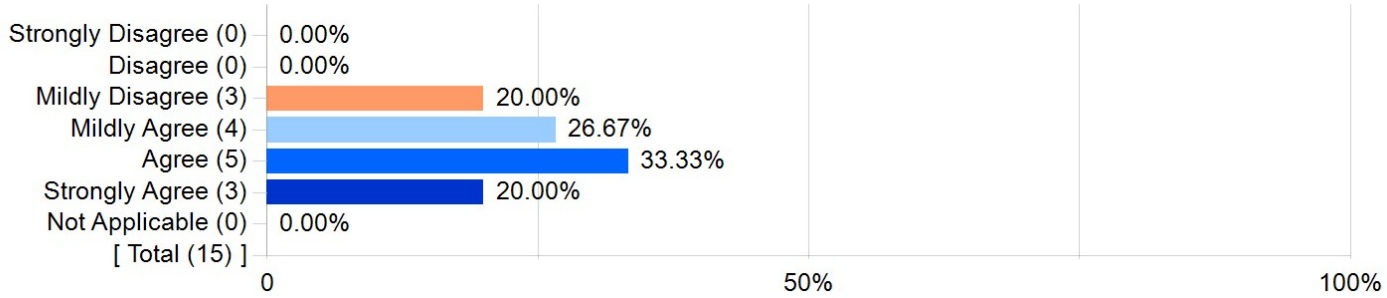
2. Content organised in a clear and logical way



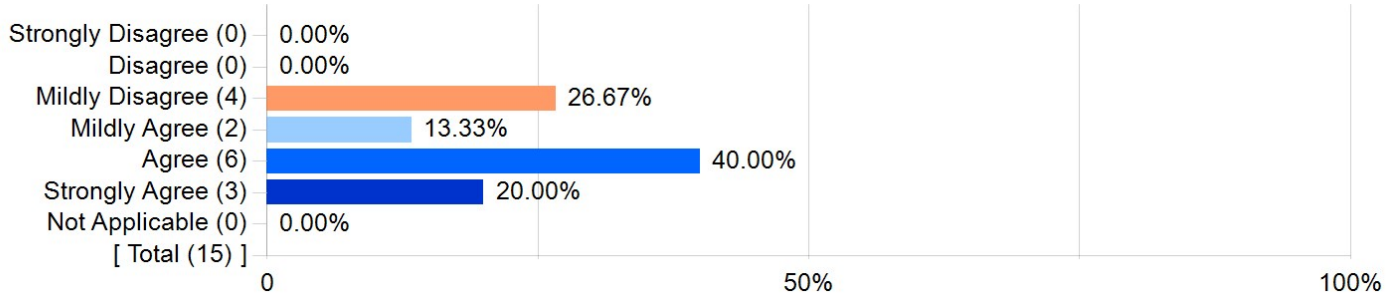
3. Subject challenged my thinking



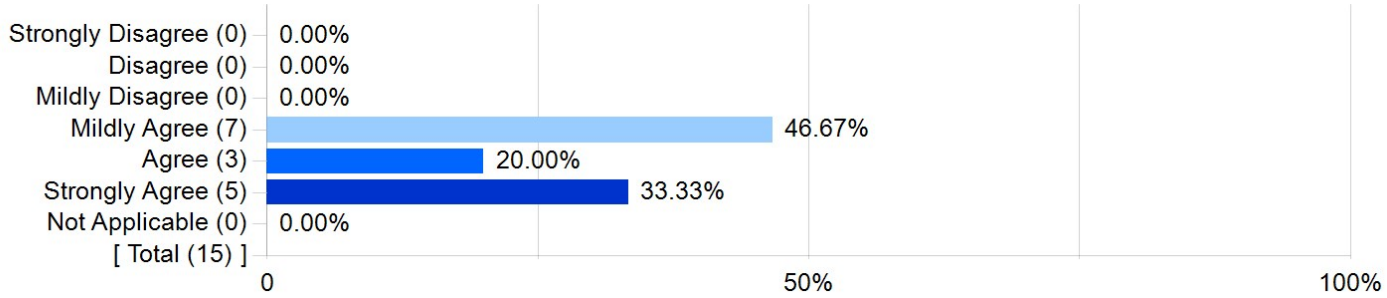
4. Learning materials aided my learning



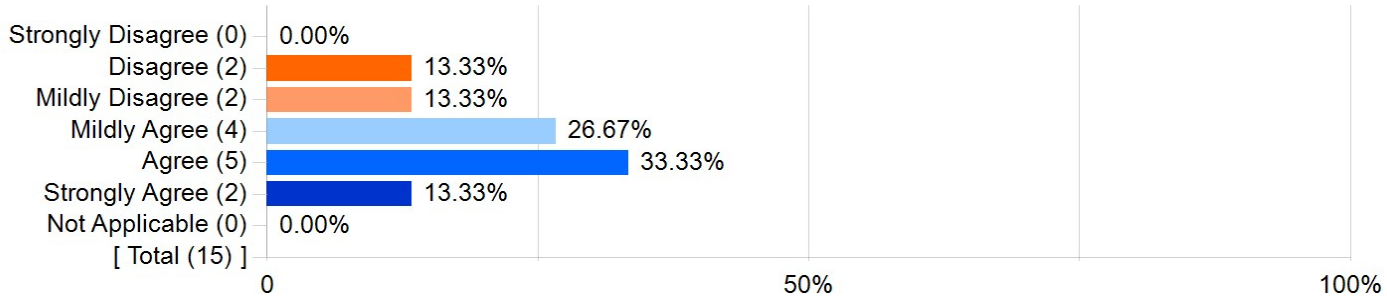
5. Technology aided my learning



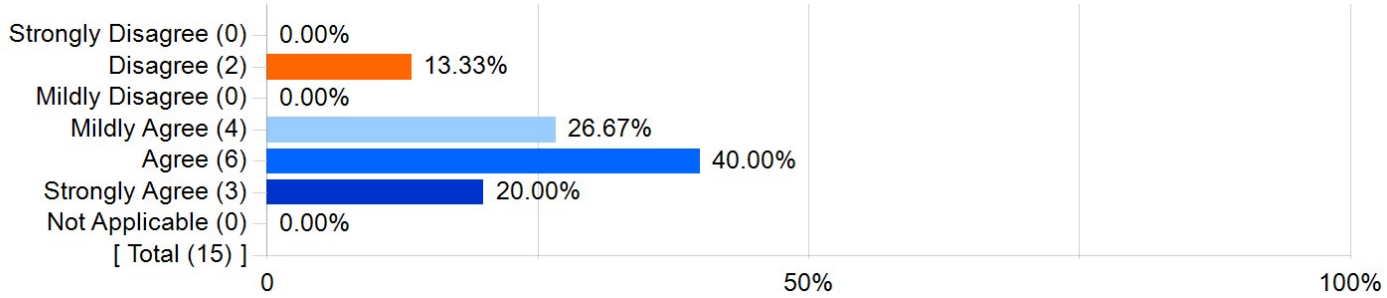
6. Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice



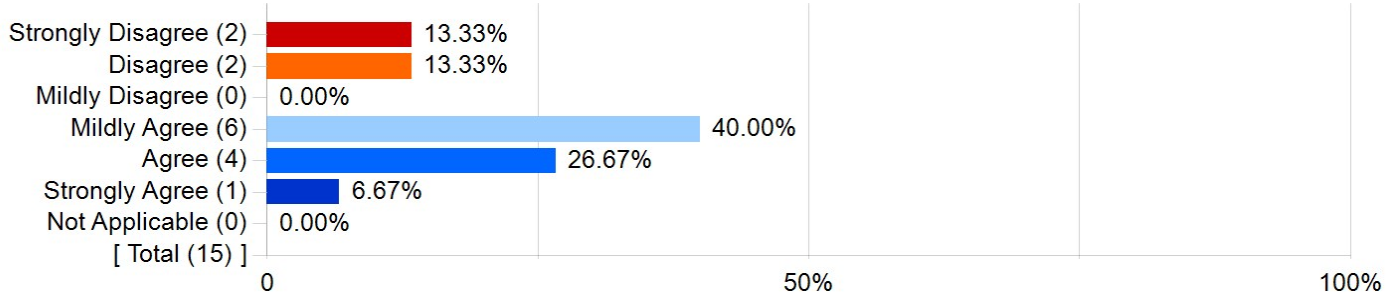
7. Assessment tasks clearly stated



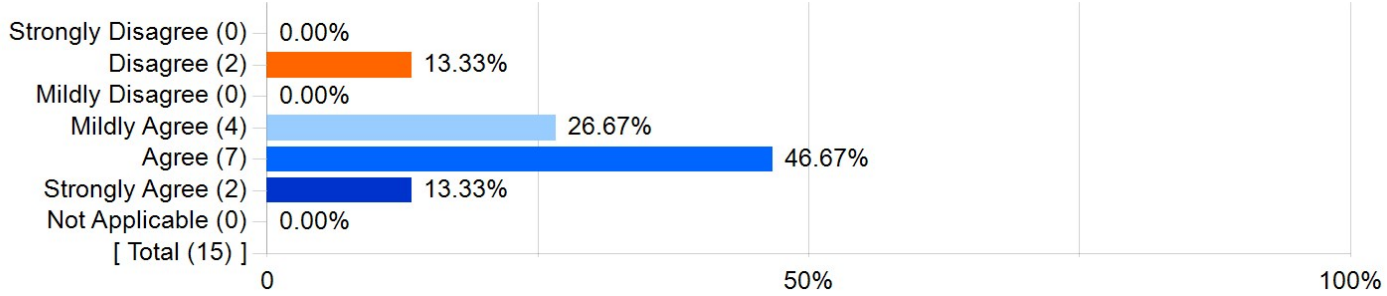
8. Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes



9. Timely feedback helped my learning

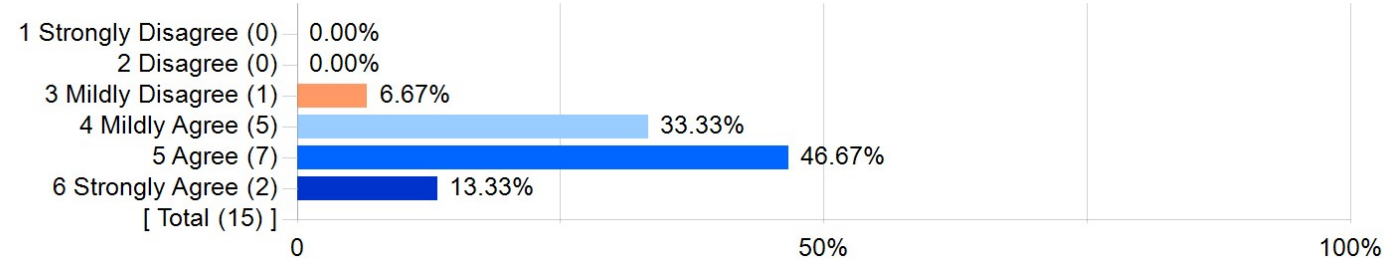


10. Overall satisfaction

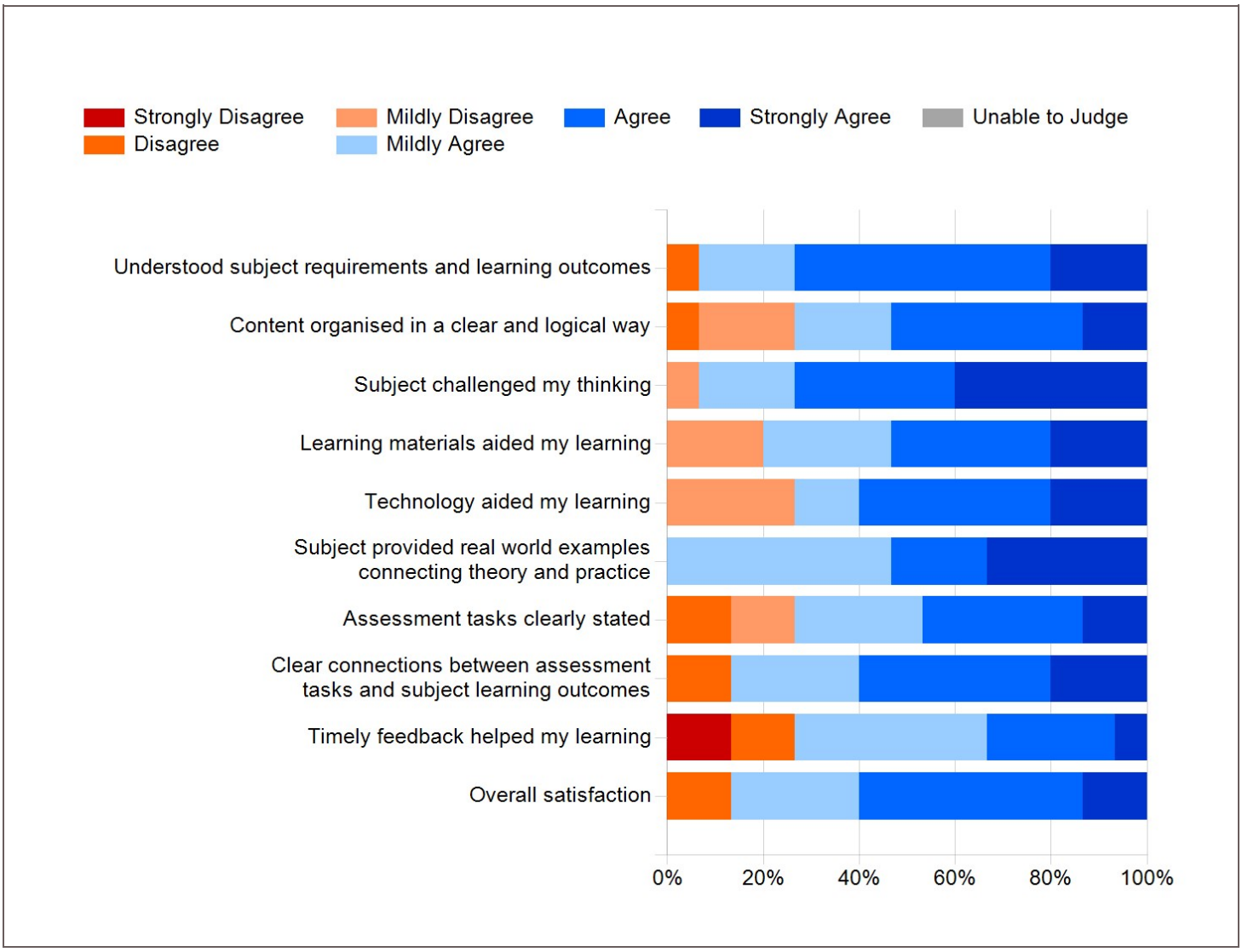


Strategic Initiative Questions

13. The Moodle site for this subject had a clear layout and was easy to navigate.



Response Distribution


Strongly Disagree
Disagree
Mildly Disagree
Mildly Agree
Agree
Strongly Agree
Unable to Judge
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes
Content organised in a clear and logical way
Subject challenged my thinking
Learning materials aided my learning
Technology aided my learning
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice
Assessment tasks clearly stated
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes
Timely feedback helped my learning
Overall satisfaction
0%
20%
40%
60%
80%
100%

Breakdown of Responses by Campus

The table below shows the means for each campus across each of the core questions. Campuses only appear in the results when there were six (6) or more responses for that campus.

Subject Evaluation Questions

Campus	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
Overall	4.80	4.33	5.07	4.53	4.53	4.87	4.20	4.53	3.73	4.47
Wollongong	4.80	4.33	5.07	4.53	4.53	4.87	4.20	4.53	3.73	4.47

Response Analysis - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

Question	% Agreeable
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	93.33%
Content organised in a clear and logical way	73.33%
Subject challenged my thinking	93.33%
Learning materials aided my learning	80.00%
Technology aided my learning	73.33%
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	100.00%
Assessment tasks clearly stated	73.33%
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	86.67%
Timely feedback helped my learning	73.33%
Overall satisfaction	86.67%

Response Analysis for School - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

Question	% Agreeable
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	97.28%
Content organised in a clear and logical way	94.88%
Subject challenged my thinking	97.71%
Learning materials aided my learning	96.17%
Technology aided my learning	96.27%
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	95.96%
Assessment tasks clearly stated	94.66%
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	95.53%
Timely feedback helped my learning	91.16%
Overall satisfaction	94.44%

Qualitative comments

11. What were the best aspects of this subject?

Comments
the molecular modelling was interesting
Learning the use of industry software, from genetics such as BLAST to structural such as ChimeraX.
I thoroughly enjoyed this subject. I found it thought provoking and informative for real life applications. In particular I enjoyed the lecture content from Dr Dezarae Cox and Dr Nickolas Johnston. Dr Haibo Yu, I felt his content I enjoyed the most! The Phylogenetics report and the assessment using Chimera was also quite fun. This is my favourite subject I've taken at UOW.
I really enjoyed learning to use some computer software and getting to do my own alignment of genomes, creating phylogenetic trees and visualising proteins. Dezerae was great lecturer and most of the lecturers were really good with bringing in practical things into the lectures so there was a benefit to going over just watching at home. the little quizzes and such were really appreciated.
The computer labs definitely aided us to work on our assessments.
Some of the lectures were very friendly and nice to talk to, namely Prof. Dezerae
the attendance not being necessary unless needed
Haibo's tutorial on protein structure – helped break down some exam style questions.
I enjoyed learning how to use molecular modelling (ChimeraX) to assist in describing the structure and function of proteins. I have already adopted these techniques elsewhere in my degree.
Lectures were super engaging and the content was very interesting!
The programs/websites used were really interesting. Learning how to make phylogenic trees and using ChimeraX was great.

12. What changes would you suggest for this subject?

Comments
possibly add tutorials (even if just optional) for help/guidance with the previous weeks lecture content.
I understand that you are a business that is already cutting classes out of existence, but you should stop doing that and start making more classes instead. This subject desperately needs to be 2 different subjects. It is begging for it. There is almost no connection between genomics and structural biology that can be explained in 13 weeks. It just can't. You cannot adequately explain transcriptomics, genomics, protein chemistry and analysis in 13 weeks. That is not enough weeks. All the information given to students is extremely surface level that will prepare us the barest minimum for actually work. X–ray crystallography, Cryo–EM and NMR had about 1 hour total covering the each of them. You need far more time to teach the intricacies of these extremely relevant techniques. This subject needs to be two subjects, one focused on structural biology and the characterisation of proteins, and another focusing on genomics and genetic analysis.
I believe professor Gokhan Tolun is a wonderful teacher. However, I found it difficult to recieve help during the last assignment in class. My classmates and myself found that by sitting on the other side of the classroom, we did not receive as much attention, to the point where some of us stayed back when we were expected to leave and waited an extra 40 minutes. I understand it is not the professors fault, having extra staff in class may be difficult in UOW's budget as I have noticed since being at UOW since 2019 that there are not as many staff to help and it is at no fault for any professors. This is more a UOW issue. I also did not recieve replies from 2 emails from a certain professor. The other thing was the quality of audio for week 12 lectures. Also, I love how all of the lectures are based on real–life applications, however some content was hard to distinguish whether it was assessable or not (or a real–life example not to be assessed). This is still my favourite subject of my time being at UOW
The subject was a little heavily weighted on the front half of semester in terms of time that needed to be dedicated to it. that happened to work well for me with other subjects I was taking but definitely could make the start of semester very difficult for some students. I understand it is hard to give an example of how to present the protein report without giving answers, but it was stressful to do a completely new type of assessment task with no example as to what was expected. Exams were fine but the final exam had some vague questions (maybe have one word answers be a drop down menu of 5 options rather than a box?). Also audio quality was poor in many lecture recordings due to lack of a mic beings used or otherwise poor use of it.
Having a better marking criteria for the assessments.
Allow review of quiz questions and answers for future revision, I don't see the student value in restricting access to this information and it appears to be a detriment. Actually provide feedback for assessments when it is requested by students so that they can improve. Providing marking rubrics for all assignments so that it is clear what is being assessed in each assignment.
to have a better reply system with teachers
More tutorial style presentations
Would have been great to receive more detailed feedback on the modelling project / a general statement summarizing where people fell short. Also (as Dezerae said) I wouldn't dedicate so much time to protein purification as we have covered this quite extensively in prerequisite classes (rather I would probably opt to spend more time covering x–ray crystallography)
Make the expectations/criteria of the ChimeraX report more obvious. Writing "Covid spike protein..... /7" is not a helpful criteria indicator. Did you want blurbs about each molecule or just straight answers to the questions in the subject manual? Make it clearer next time.

Session and Year Details : Spring - 2024

Locations Included : Wollongong

Delivery modes: On Campus